Homa Bay town, Homa Bay County, Kenya

Here El Niño arrives as lake backflow, river floods, and the cholera, malaria, and broken HIV treatment that follow them, not as heat. The single most important action is to get cholera and diarrhoea stock to the beaches and the town's settlements before the November rains, and to keep it there until the lake falls in mid-2027.

IMPACT REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
Not retrievable at this resolution. Containing geography: Homa Bay County (~1.13M, 2019 census)	No figure published for Kenya or East Africa	n/a (global: 451,000, Jun 2026 – Feb 2027)	Lake backflow and river floods; cholera, malaria, drowning

15/16 recommendations verified. 0 confirmed without correction, 13 corrected, 1 unverified (not sent to a verifier), 2 contraindicated. The funding target moved 6% in verification, from ~$1.10M to ~$1.03M; the ceiling fell 25%. Exposure figure: Climate Impact Lab, September 2026, pre-peer-review. It covers heat only and publishes no Kenyan figure, so no excess-death number appears here, scaled or otherwise. The local record below carries the hazard.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



0.53°S 34.46°E, Kenya · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** Lake backflow and river floods, then cholera, malaria, and broken HIV treatment. The deadliest flood comes in the long rains after a wet short-rains season, so the danger runs to April–May 2027.
- **First action.** County Health and Kenya Red Cross put ORS, zinc, chlorine, and rehydration points at the landing beaches and the town's settlements by 15 November.
- **The money.** ~$374k floor, ~$1.03M target, ~$1.82M ceiling. Most lives per dollar: ~$90k for the community health promoters' surge allowance and kits.
- **Do not.** Lobbying for bigger Jinja dam releases: they lower the lake by about 4 cm and push the flood into South Sudan.

What to do	**14** actions	p. 2
Who does what	RACI chart	p. 13
Where money does the most	funding	p. 14
Do not do this	**5** items	p. 15
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* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

EXPOSURE, HONESTLY

A LAKE THAT RISES AFTER THE RAIN

- **Where.** Homa Bay town is the county seat on the Lake Victoria shore (Homa Bay Town constituency, ~117,000 people, 2019 census). The county holds about 1.13 million people. Flooding concentrates in Rachuonyo North (Kobuya, Osodo, Simbi, Chuowe), Karachuonyo along the Kibuon, Awach Tende, and Miriu rivers, Suba and Mbita, the islands (Rusinga, Mfangano, Remba), and the town's dense settlements (Shauri Yako, Makongeni, Soko Mjinga, Sofia), where floodwater mixes with sewage.
- **This season.** The Kenya Meteorological Department's October–December 2026 outlook puts the Lake Victoria basin, Homa Bay included, in its above-average rainfall group, with heavy-rain events likely.
- **The lake lags the rain.** After the wet 1961 short rains the lake peaked in May 1964; after the 2019 short rains it set a record 13.42 m at Jinja on 7 May 2020; after the 2023 El Niño short rains, April–May 2024 brought the county's worst displacement. **The danger here does not end with this winter's peak; it runs to April–May 2027.**
- **Who dies.** Homa Bay's under-5 mortality is 61 per 1,000 (KDHS 2022) against 41 nationally. Adult HIV prevalence is the highest in Kenya (15.2%, NSDCC 2023 estimate; the Ministry of Health now reports about 11.7%). Lake fishers die of HIV, drowning, TB, and malaria. The documented flood deaths are drownings, a handful per event; the larger toll, if it comes, comes weeks later from cholera, malaria, and interrupted treatment.
- **The calendar collides.** KCSE exams run 19 October – 20 November 2026, in the kind of schools Homa Bay used as flood shelters in 2020 and 2024.
- **Heat is not the story.** Climate Impact Lab's projection covers heat only and publishes nothing for Kenya or East Africa. Heat was not assessed by any lens and is listed as a blind spot.

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO

RANKED

Ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. Backing lenses are shown per action. Convergence was checked for shared bias: the ORS, chlorine, bednet, and community-health evidence is canonical global literature, so these actions are ranked on the local record

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

(1997, 2015, and 2023 cholera; 2024 shelters in schools and a dispensary), not on lens agreement.

1. Put ORS and zinc, household chlorine, and oral rehydration points at the landing beaches and the town's settlements by mid-November, linked to treatment beds

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MGR · HISTORIAN · SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE · PHILANTHROPIST

ADAPTATION INVENTORY: CLOSEST IS HUMANITARIAN PREPAREDNESS, PAKISTAN 2025

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Homa Bay County Health, with Kenya Red Cross	15 Nov 2026	~$100k (placement 2); no published cost per life	Diarrhoea and cholera deaths after the floods

Where: Sindo and Wadiang'a beaches (Suba), Kendu Bay, Mbita, and Shauri Yako, Makongeni, Soko Mjinga, and Sofia in town, referring to Suba Sub-County Hospital and the County Teaching and Referral Hospital. Chlorine goes out with a demonstration, not as a hand-out.

Why here: cholera reached Homa Bay in the 1997–98 El Niño (first case in Nyatike, 25 June 1997; WHO counted about 2,500 cases and 140 deaths in Nyanza by 28 October). In 2015 the county had over 1,000 cases and 17 deaths. In May 2023 an outbreak began among fishers at Wadiang'a and Sindo: 73 cases and one child's death. No Homa Bay case has been confirmed since 2023, and Kenya declared its last outbreak over on 27 January 2026.

Evidence: ORS was associated with 69% lower diarrhoea mortality in under-5s (95% CI 51–80; Munos et al. 2010), but that pools only three low-quality quasi-experimental studies. Household chlorination cut diarrhoea by 23% (RR 0.77, 0.65–0.91; Clasen 2015 Cochrane, 14 trials, low certainty).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: high. The 2023 outbreak started among the same fishers and traders this targets. Corrected in verification: the 1997 figures of 4,571 cases and 228 deaths are IRIN's, not WHO's.

2. Pay community health promoters in the flood wards their arrears and a three-month surge allowance, and equip them with treatment kits and a household roster

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PHILANTHROPIST · FRONTLINE · PUBLIC HEALTH

ADAPTATION INVENTORY: PRECEDENT, COMMUNITY HEALTH WORKERS IN UGANDA (BJÖRKMAN NYQVIST ET AL.)

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Homa Bay County Health (CHMT)	Allowance and kits by 31 Oct 2026	~$90k (placement 1)	Child deaths from malaria and diarrhoea in cut-off households

What: a KES 1,500-a-month surge allowance for three months for about 1,500 of the county's ~2,954 promoters in flood wards, on top of the national KES 5,000 stipend. Add kits with malaria rapid tests, ACTs, ORS, and zinc. Each promoter lists bedridden people, people on ART, pregnant women, and child-headed homes, and records who will move them and where.

Evidence: in a 214-village RCT in Uganda, community health promoters cut under-5 mortality by 27% (Nyqvist et al. 2019). The Adaptation Inventory entry from the same Ugandan villages found community care offset 46% of the extra infant-death risk after low rainfall (J Dev Econ 2025). That is a drought finding, so it transfers only partly to flood-season malaria.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrected in verification: the lens proposed "topping up" promoters from KES 2,000 to 3,500. The national stipend has been KES 5,000 (2,500 national, 2,500 county) since 2023–24, so that would have been a pay cut. Payment is often late, and clearing arrears is the first use of money. Living Goods works in Kisumu, Vihiga, and Busia, not Homa Bay.

3. Give established, virally suppressed people on ART in the flood wards, beaches, and islands a three-month refill by 15 November, once NASCOP confirms stock*

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MGR · FRONTLINE · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
County Health, with NASCOP and community HIV groups	15 Nov 2026	Drugs from the national programme; outreach ~$50k (placement 3)	Treatment interruptions when roads and clinics flood

Evidence: in the INTERVAL cluster RCT (Malawi and Zambia), six-month dispensing kept 12-month retention non-inferior to standard care. In Malawi, treatment interruptions rose 23–24% in flood months. Kenya's 2022 guidelines allow multi-month dispensing for established clients, and six-month refills are covered under a later SOP.

Feasibility risk: NASCOP reported a TAF/3TC/DTG shortage and restricted dispensing on 28 May 2026. A blanket 3–6-month refill may not be possible, so stock has to be cleared first. Donors fund at least two-thirds of Kenya's HIV spending, and Global Fund HIV money for the next cycle is down 18.2%. Who currently funds outreach in Homa Bay could not be confirmed.

4. Designate evacuation sites before 31 October that are not schools or clinics, sit above the flood line, and have latrines and chlorination in place before they open, planned for months not days

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · SKEPTIC · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: CLOSEST IS HUMANITARIAN PREPAREDNESS, PAKISTAN 2025

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
County Commissioner and County Disaster Committee	31 Oct 2026	Not costed; site WASH partly in placement 2	Camp cholera; a dispensary taken offline; exams disrupted

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Why: in April 2024, flooding affected 1,731 households in the county; about 1,057 sheltered in Kobuya and Osodo schools and at Simbi dispensary. In 2020, some lakeshore families were still displaced months later, because lake backflow does not drain in a week. KCSE exams run 19 October – 20 November, and these schools are exam centres. Agree return rights with the Beach Management Units in writing, so moving people is not read as eviction.

Not verified: any 2026 update to the county's September 2023 El Niño preparedness plan. Red Cross held drills in May 2026.

5. Relay the daily Lake Victoria fishing forecast at every landing beach, and get boat owners and Beach Management Unit chairs to agree that nobody sails on a red day

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · EMERGENCY MGR · PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Beach Management Units, with KMD and the Kenya Maritime Authority	Running by 1 Nov 2026	Volunteer time and airtime. Unfunded	Storm drownings of fishers and passengers

What: a volunteer at each beach chalks up the KMD Lake Victoria forecast colour and sends it by WhatsApp in Dholuo and Suba. The Kenya Maritime Authority checks life jackets and stops mixed passenger-and-cargo boats on warning days at Homa Bay pier and on the island routes. In September 2021, an overloaded boat with cement and timber sank off the pier and 7–8 people died, without life jackets.

Evidence: WMO reports weather-related deaths on the lake fell 30% under the HIGHWAY forecast project, but that is the project's own "likely" estimate, not an independent evaluation; about 75% of users acted on forecasts. No study measures life-jacket effect in low-income fisheries.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrected: KMD's public archive of the forecast stops at 29 November 2024, so confirm the feed is live before relying on it. WMO's 3,000–5,000 deaths a year covers all boat users on the whole lake, not fishers alone. The frontline lens's point stands: fishers stay ashore when the boat owner and the waiting trader agree, not when a chief says so.

6. Agree one warning voice and one trigger, then stand up night-whistle volunteers and painted river gauges in the flood villages

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | HISTORIAN · FRONTLINE · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
County Disaster Committee and county met office; village volunteers	Agreement by 25 Oct; volunteers by 1 Nov 2026	Near zero; staff gauges not costed. Unfunded	Night-time flood deaths; warnings ignored because officials contradict each other

Why: on 22 October 2023 President Ruto said the El Niño alert had been downscaled. KMD apologised for the "miscommunication" on 10 November, and State House blamed KMD, so who caused it is still disputed. No gauge was found on the Kibuon, Awach Tende, or Miriu. The Kibuon burst its banks in May 2025 and displaced more than 200 households in Karachuonyo. Start with a painted staff gauge read by volunteers. The Nile Basin Initiative gauge at Ogilo (installed August 2024) is on the Nyando in Kisumu, so it is a model, not a source.

Not verified: the Simbi Kogembo night-whistle precedent. No published evaluation shows community flood warnings cut deaths. This action ranks on the local mechanism, not on an effect size.

7. Get the nets already in homes hung now, with door-to-door checks at the beaches, and confirm whether Homa Bay is in a 2026 net round

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · PHILANTHROPIST · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
County Health; community health promoters do the checks	Phone call this week; checks by mid-Nov	Zero to confirm; $36k for displaced households only, held (placement 4)	A post-flood malaria surge in a lake-endemic county

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Evidence: nets cut all-cause child mortality by 17% (RR 0.83, 0.77–0.89; Pryce 2018 Cochrane). Homa Bay received 841,000 nets in November 2023, so they reach about three years old at this peak. The RTS,S malaria vaccine has been given in Ndhiwa, Rachuonyo East, and Rangwe since 2019. In the pilot, all-cause mortality among eligible children was 13% lower, a figure pooled across Ghana, Kenya, and Malawi. A catch-up push on missed doses belongs here.

Corrected: no source confirms a "10 million nets from November" campaign in 2026, so do not plan around new nets before the peak. Lake Victoria has a documented history of nets being used for fishing and drying fish, so a mass hand-out without hanging checks is listed under *Do not do this*.

8. Kenya Red Cross HQ files an IFRC imminent-event DREF the moment a short-range forecast shows the Homa Bay rivers flooding

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · EMERGENCY MGR · PHILANTHROPIST

ADAPTATION INVENTORY: PRECEDENT, ANTICIPATORY FLOOD CASH, BANGLADESH 2021 AND 2025, NEPAL 2025

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Kenya Red Cross HQ (Homa Bay branch delivers)	1 month to 3 days before forecast impact	~CHF 75,000 lump sum, paid by IFRC	Money arriving after the photographs, not before the flood

What exists: Kenya Red Cross's riverine-flood Early Action Protocol covers only the Tana, Nzoia, and Athi basins. Its timeframe ran to 3 October 2026, and no renewal was found. The imminent-event DREF is the open door. It pays about CHF 75,000, for rapid-onset hazards only, with at least 75% spent on early action. No Kenya imminent DREF for these short rains has been found, so this is not redundant.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrected: the seasonal outlook alone does not trigger it. It needs a short-range river-flood forecast, and slow lake backflow may not count as rapid onset. The November 2023 operation the lens cited (MDRKE058) was an Emergency Appeal for 250,000 people, not a DREF for 6,000 households.

9. Draft the oral cholera vaccine request to the ICG now, ready to file within 7 days of a confirmed case, alongside the stock in action 1 and not instead of it

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
County Health, through the Ministry of Health with WHO or UNICEF	Dossier ready by 31 Oct 2026	Vaccine from the ICG stockpile; delivery not costed	Weeks of paperwork once an outbreak starts

Preventive vaccination resumed on 4 February 2026, but the first 20 million doses went to Mozambique, DRC, and Bangladesh, and no Kenya allocation was found. ICG requests are reactive and must come from the Ministry or a partner agency. Kenya ran reactive campaigns in 2023, so the route has precedent.

Evidence: one dose gave about 40% protection at six months, with no significant protection in children aged 1–4 (Qadri 2016, Bangladesh, cited from memory). Doses arrive after an outbreak has started.

10. Keep the stock, shelters, warnings, and money in place through the April–May 2027 long rains, not just this winter

UNVERIFIED (NOT SENT TO A VERIFIER) | HISTORIAN · EMERGENCY MGR · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
County Disaster Committee	Decision by 15 Dec 2026; hold to 31 May 2027	Extends actions 1–6; not separately costed	Being stood down just before the worst flood

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The Historian's pattern: 1961 short rains, then the 1964 lake peak; 2019 short rains, then the May 2020 record; 2023 El Niño short rains, then April–May 2024, when four people drowned in Suba South and the county's governor said the state was "not doing enough". The individual events were checked in verification; the claim that the pattern will repeat in 2027 was not.

The Skeptic's version of the same point: a campaign branded "El Niño" ends when the event fades, while the lake stays high. Fund the recurring response, not the event.

11. Pre-position maize and beans for the islands, use cash or vouchers on the mainland, and get hermetic bags out before the wet December–January harvest

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FOOD SUPPLY | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
County Departments of Agriculture and Fisheries, with NCPB	Island stock by 15 Nov; bags by 15 Dec 2026	Not costed; bag price (~KES 250) dates from 2013–18	Island isolation; a good harvest becoming aflatoxin-contaminated stock

FEWS NET (September 2026) puts Kenya's long-rains maize output 22–28% below average, with prices rising October–December. Wetter short rains should help the next harvest, so the El Niño food signal here is **weak to moderate**. Homa Bay town's markets work, so cash beats in-kind help on the mainland; in-kind makes sense only for Remba, Mfangano, and Rusinga if transport breaks. Hermetic bags kept stored maize below 10 ppb aflatoxin in KALRO trials.

Triggers: only KMD's Lake basin forecasts are usable. Homa Bay is not one of NDMA's 23 ASAL counties, so it has no monthly early-warning bulletin, and no recent Homa Bay maize series was found in KAMIS; use FEWS NET or WFP market data instead.

12. Pilot a few solar tent dryers at the main omena beaches, priced from local quotes, before scaling

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FOOD SUPPLY | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
County Fisheries, with Beach Management Units	Before mid-Nov 2026	No published cost; get local quotes	Losing the cheapest protein when it rains on the drying grounds

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Omena is the protein of poor households here, and it is sun-dried on open ground. Kenyan studies report 20–50% spoilage in rainy seasons. Solar tents gave the lowest microbial loads, with no E. coli detected. Homa Bay got a freezer (Nyandiwa) and a smoking kiln (Mbita) under a 2025 CGIAR project; the tents went to Migori.

Corrected: the effect on loss is unmeasured, and one Tanzanian study runs the wrong way (tents 24.9% loss against racks 14.9%). The lens's KES 30–80k cost is unsupported. That is why this is a pilot.

13. Fund pre-peak preparedness through a supplementary appropriation and FLLoCA, not by pre-authorising the Emergency Fund

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · ECONOMIST · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
County Treasury (CEC Finance) and County Assembly	Assembly sitting before 15 Nov 2026	No new money; reallocates the county's own	County money that only moves after the flood

Homa Bay passed the FLLoCA third performance assessment and received about KES 161M from IDA for FY2025/26, plus about KES 156M of its own contribution. That was the final Phase I tranche, and the lawsuit over ward committees did not block it. A supplementary appropriation is the lawful route for forecast-driven spending. The Emergency Fund is for spending after the event (see *Do not do this*).

Not verified: whether the ward climate committees exist now, and the lawsuit's outcome.

14. Press the State Department for Social Protection to pay the October and November Inua Jamii cycles on time

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FOOD SUPPLY · ECONOMIST · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: RELATED, KENYA HUNGER SAFETY NET CASH TRANSFERS (2025)

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
State Department for Social Protection	Nov 2026	No new money	Older people cutting meals as prices rise

About 20,342 older people in Homa Bay are on Inua Jamii, at KES 2,000 a month, paid monthly in arrears. The June 2026 cycle started paying only on 3 August.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrected and demoted: the lens's "pay early and top up in flood wards" is unrealistic. Payments already run 1–2 months late, and Homa Bay is not an ASAL county covered by the Hunger Safety Net Programme, so it has no standing flood top-up mechanism.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	County Health (CHMT)	Community health promoters	Kenya Red Cross	County Commissioner & Disaster Committee	KMD & county met	Beach Mgmt Units & boat owners	Kenya Maritime Authority	Village volunteers	Ministry of Health (NASCOP, NMP)	County Agriculture & Fisheries	County Treasury & Assembly	State Dept Social Protection
1. Cholera and ORS stock at beaches and settlements	**A**	**R**	**R**	**I**		**C**						
2. Health promoter arrears, surge allowance, and kits	**A/R**	**R**							**C**		**C**	
3. Three-month ART refills, flood wards	**A/R**	**R**				**C**			**C**			
4. Non-school, non-clinic shelters with WASH	**C**		**R**	**A/R**		**C**					**I**	
5. Lake forecast relay; red-day rule; life jackets				**I**	**C**	**A/R**	**R**	**R**		**C**		
6. One warning voice; whistles; staff gauges			**C**	**A/R**	**R**	**I**		**R**				
7. Hang existing nets; confirm 2026 round	**A**	**R**				**C**			**C**			
8. Imminent-event DREF request	**I**		**A/R**	**C**	**C**							
9. ICG cholera vaccine dossier	**A/R**								**R**			
10. Hold everything to May 2027	**R**		**R**	**A**	**C**						**C**	
11. Island food stock; cash on mainland; hermetic bags			**C**	**C**						**A/R**	**C**	
12. Omena solar dryer pilot						**R**				**A/R**		
13. Supplementary appropriation; FLLoCA	**C**			**C**							**A/R**	
14. Inua Jamii cycles on time				**I**								**A/R**

What the chart shows: County Health is accountable for five rows, and its delivery arm, the community health promoters, is responsible on five. The binding constraint there is promoters being paid at all, not new staff. The Disaster Committee holds three rows that need a decision, not money: shelters, one warning voice, and holding everything to May 2027. Rows 5 and 12 belong to the Beach Management Units, which officials do not command; boat owners decide who sails. Row 8 can only be filed by Kenya Red Cross headquarters, and row 14 sits with a national department Homa Bay cannot direct.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs.

FLOOR	TARGET	CEILING	LARGEST UNCERTAINTY
~$374k	~$1.03M	~$1.82M	How many households are displaced (cash is 73% of target)

Floor: 1,000 promoters × $60 ($35 surge allowance + $25 kit) = $60k; 1,057 households × $250 cash = $264k (1,057 = households in camps, April 2024); water and ORS $50k. Total $374k.
Target: $90k promoters + $100k water and ORS + $50k HIV outreach + $36k nets (conditional) + $750k cash (3,000 × $250) = $1,026k.
Ceiling: 2,950 promoters × $60 = $177k; 3,000 households × $464 = $1,392k; water $100k; HIV $100k; nets $48k. Total $1,817k. Cash is capped at 3,000 households, because more has no delivery precedent here.
How the numbers moved: the target fell 6% and the ceiling 25%. The promoter line was rebuilt after the original design turned out to be a pay cut. $250 per household is a judgement, not a published transfer value. The lens's lower anchor (CHF 125 from MDRKE058) was withdrawn, because that operation was an appeal for 250,000 people. The upper anchor, GiveDirectly's KES 60,000 (~$464), was a post-flood payment in Garsen, not an anticipatory one.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
Homa Bay County Dept of Health, via community health promoters	Action 2: surge allowance (1,500 × KES 1,500 × 3 months) and treatment kits	$90k ($52k + $38k)	Top-up to the existing stipend scheme	Nyqvist 2019, Uganda RCT: under-5 mortality −27%, ~$68 per life-year (programme sources). GiveWell: $4,400–37,000 per life saved	Partially confirmed (original design contraindicated)
County public health, with Kenya Red Cross	Action 1: chlorine, ORS points, and cholera units at beaches and settlements	$100k	Pre-positioned stock	No published cost per life. Effect: Clasen 2015 diarrhoea RR 0.77; Munos 2010 ORS	Unverified (cost)

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
County HIV programme and community HIV groups	Action 3: outreach so displaced patients get multi-month refills	$50k	Direct grant	No cost-per-death figure; placed on judgement. INTERVAL RCT (retention)	Unverified (funder overlap unknown)
County Health	Action 7: nets for displaced households only (3,000 × 2 × $6)	$36k, conditional	Pre-positioned stock	AMF, $3,000–8,000 per life saved (GiveWell, multi-country). Hold until the 2026 national round is confirmed	Partially confirmed, hold
Kenya Red Cross (HQ, delivered by the Homa Bay branch via M-Pesa)	Action 8: anticipatory cash on a river-flood forecast, alongside an IFRC imminent DREF	$750k (3,000 × $250)	Anticipatory cash transfer	Pople et al. 2021 (Bangladesh): 36% fewer days without food. A welfare result, not deaths. No Homa Bay branch cash record found	Partially confirmed

The funder's one thing: the cheapest life saved here is the one reached by the ~2,954 community health promoters the county already has, if they are paid what they are owed. Cash is the biggest line and looks best on a flood map, but it buys the fewest lives per dollar. Fund rows 1–3 first, and call the Ministry about nets before buying any.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

The first two items received a CONTRAINDICATED verdict in verification. The rest are documented ways responses have gone wrong on this lake

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

or in comparable Kenyan floods.

Lobbying for bigger dam releases at Jinja as a flood-safety measure this season

CONTRAINDICATED HISTORIAN PROPOSED; VERIFIER REJECTED

An extra 1,000 m³/s for 30 days removes about 2.6 km³ of water, about 4 cm off a 68,800 km² lake (verifier's arithmetic), against a 2019–20 rise of more than a metre. In 2020 Jinja released 2,200–2,600 m³/s, more than double normal, and the lake still set its record. Higher releases fed Nile flooding in South Sudan. Releases follow the Agreed Curve and an EAC dispute that no MP can change in weeks.

Instead: treat the lake level as fixed for this season and plan shelters and stock to last until it falls (actions 4 and 10).

A County Assembly resolution pre-authorising the Emergency Fund on a weather advisory

CONTRAINDICATED ECONOMIST PROPOSED; VERIFIER REJECTED

Under the Homa Bay County Emergency Fund Act 2016, the CEC Member for Finance decides payments, only for "urgent and unforeseen" needs, capped at 2% of audited revenue, and the Assembly approves them afterwards within two months. A resolution tying spending to a forecast conflicts with the "unforeseen" test and would invite an audit query that freezes the fund when it is needed.

Instead: a supplementary appropriation now, plus FLLoCA money (action 13), and keep the Emergency Fund for the response.

Opening camps in schools, or in a dispensary, and adding water and latrines later

DOCUMENTED HARM

In 2024, Homa Bay families sheltered at Simbi dispensary, taking it offline, and in Kobuya and Osodo schools. In Tana River, May 2024, there were 57 cholera cases across 88 camps. This year the schools are KCSE exam centres until 20 November.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: non-school, non-clinic sites above the flood line, with WASH in place before they open (action 4).

Riparian demolitions or forced relocation presented as evacuation

DOCUMENTED HARM, COMPARABLE SETTING

In Nairobi in 2024, bulldozers cleared riparian homes with no alternative shelter, and at least one person died. On the lake, camps re-form "at least once every year" in Rachuonyo North because no one was ever relocated. Eviction teaches people to stay put the next time they are told to move.

Instead: evacuation with written return rights agreed through the Beach Management Units.

A mass bednet hand-out at the beaches with no hanging checks

DOCUMENTED DIVERSION

Studies in Lake Victoria fishing villages (including Suba, now in Homa Bay) found free nets used to dry fish and to fish. Local fishery leaders blame mosquito-net fishing for falling stocks.

Instead: door-to-door checks that existing nets are hung (action 7), and new nets only to displaced households.

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE — THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
1961–64	Wet 1961 short rains; Lake Victoria peaks at 13.41 m (Jinja) in May 1964	Not found	A record that held for 56 years
1997–98	El Niño cholera, from Nyatike (25 June 1997) to Homa Bay, Rachuonyo, Suba, and Kisumu	~2,500 cases and 140 deaths in Nyanza by 28 Oct 1997 (WHO); no Homa Bay-only figure	Nothing documented

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
2015	Cholera in Homa Bay	Over 1,000 cases, 17 deaths	—
Dec 2019	Kuja and Miriu rivers flood	3 drowned; 389 displaced	—
Apr–May 2020	Lake record, 13.42 m on 7 May; backflow along the Homa Bay shore	800+ families displaced, 95+ beaches hit; 8 deaths in Homa Bay and Kisumu	Some families displaced for months; Kenyans sued over Uganda's release policy
Sep 2021	Overloaded passenger-and-cargo boat sinks off Homa Bay pier	7–8 dead	—
May 2023	Cholera among fishers at Wadiang'a and Sindo, Suba	73 cases, 1 child dead	—
Nov 2023	El Niño short rains; Awach Tende and Miriu flood in Rachuonyo North; national El Niño messaging contradicted	500+ displaced; 1 of 160 national deaths	County El Niño plan (Sept 2023), no budget published
Apr–May 2024	Long rains after the El Niño; lake backflow at Remba and Ombaka; Kibuon floods	1,731 households affected, ~1,057 in schools and a dispensary; 4 drowned in Suba South	Governor: the state is "not doing enough"
May 2025	Kibuon bursts its banks, Karachuonyo	200+ households displaced	—

The recurrence nobody has noticed: in Homa Bay the killing flood comes in the long rains *after* a wet short-rains season, not during it: 1961 then 1964, 2019 then May 2020, 2023 then April–May 2024. The lake takes months to rise and sits high. For 2026–27, that points to April–May 2027. And the same three places recur in every row: the Rachuonyo North schools, the Suba beaches where cholera starts, and the pier.

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WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **Cash is the biggest placement** (Philanthropist, $750k) versus **cash saves the fewest lives per dollar** (the same lens, and the verifier: its evidence is about meals, not deaths). Resolved by sequence: fund promoters, cholera stock, and HIV outreach first, and cash on a real river-flood forecast, matched by the DREF.
- **Push Uganda for earlier releases** (Historian) versus **releases move the lake by centimetres and flood South Sudan** (verifier). The verifier's arithmetic settled it; it moved to *Do not do this*.
- **Pre-authorise the Emergency Fund** (Economist) versus **the Act does not allow it** (verifier). Settled by the statute; the supplementary appropriation is the lawful route.
- **Give everyone on ART 3–6 months of drugs** (Public Health, Emergency Manager) versus **NASCOP restricted dispensing in May 2026** (verifier). Unresolved until the national stock position is known: three months for established clients, six only where the SOP and stock allow.
- **This is an El Niño problem** (most lenses) versus **it is a lake problem that recurs every year** (Skeptic). Both hold; the Historian's sequence shows El Niño seasons make the following year's lake worse.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

Mental health, gender-based violence, and the fish-for-sex economy during displacement. Several lenses named jaboya and "Puk Iyier" as how HIV moves on the beaches, but none asked what months in a camp, with lost catch and trade, do to transactional sex, new HIV infections, and violence against women and girls. In a county with Kenya's highest HIV prevalence, that could matter more than several actions above, and it needs PEP and condoms at the shelters, and a protection focal point at each site.

Also uncovered: heat, a secondary hazard on a warm lake shore; obstetric referral from the islands when boats cannot sail; schistosomiasis and other water-contact disease after floods; and the Ugandan and Tanzanian shores, which share the lake and the cholera.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

The panel is author-built. Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

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Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale, roughly 300,000 people. They are not neighbourhood figures. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; drought, flood, fire, smoke, and crop failure are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED

METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The location was taken as given: Homa Bay, Kenya, built as Homa Bay town with the county's flood-prone lakeshore, because "Homa Bay" names both the town and the county and the hazards and owners are county-wide. Climate Impact Lab impact region, as the report records it: not retrievable at this resolution; containing geography Homa Bay County. Mortality figures exist only at that scale (impact regions average roughly 300,000 people); sub-city detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections or quoted from the map's GDP-denominated mortality. Where heat is not the dominant hazard, the historical record carries the hazard instead of a borrowed number.
- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, philanthropist, and food supply chain analyst) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief. National findings from the earlier Dzirive (Kwale County) briefing were passed in as claims to re-verify, not as facts.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias (whether the evidence behind an agreed action came from a setting like this one) before it counted in an action's favour. Contradictions were kept, not resolved by dropping a side. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, each was given a named payer and trigger or marked unfunded, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list.
- **Verification.** Seven verifier agents checked fifteen recommendations and the funding envelope on three tests: evidence (the primary source and its effect size), transferability (whether that evidence came from somewhere like here), and feasibility (whether it can be done here before the peak). Financial actions were also checked for availability in this jurisdiction, a named payer, a trigger threshold, and whether they already exist. Food actions were checked for whether their price triggers are actually published, forecast timing, delivery capacity, and cash versus in-kind. The funding envelope was checked for real recipients, published unit costs, and duplication, then re-summed. Action 10 (hold to May 2027) was not sent to a verifier as a whole.
- **Who does what.** The RACI chart is built from the owners named in the verified actions, with one accountable party per action. It is a proposal: no organisation named in it has been contacted or has agreed to a role.

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- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Consulted from the full 96-entry dataset embedded in the inventory page, filtered for Kenya, East Africa, flood, and health. It holds no entries on cholera, bednets, HIV, drowning, or lake flooding. Its relevant precedents are community health workers (Uganda), anticipatory flood cash (Bangladesh, Nepal), humanitarian preparedness (Pakistan), and Kenyan cash transfers.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (refills of HIV treatment) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so and shows the containing geography's number with its arithmetic. Every source is listed below with its verification status.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. KDHS 2022 county tables for net use, a fishers' drowning rate, 1997–98 Homa Bay-only figures, and the county's 2026 preparedness plan could not be retrieved. The KAMIS portal refused connections, and the county's investment page returned a 404.

References (✓ = fetched and checked by a verifier; ◦ = cited by a lens, not independently re-checked)

✓ Munos, Walker & Black 2010 · pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov · Clasen 2015 Cochrane · cochrane.org

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✓ Preventive OCV resumes, Feb 2026 · unicef.org · ICG stockpile · who.int

✓ CHP stipend · amref.org · nation.africa · Homa Bay CHVs · kenyanews.go.ke · Nyqvist et al. 2019 · poverty-action.org · GiveWell · givewell.org

✓ Malaria vaccine pilot · nation.africa · KDHS 2022 child mortality · kenyanews.go.ke · 2023 net campaign · the-star.co.ke

✓ HIV prevalence · khusoko.com · Global Fund cut · businessdailyafrica.com · Kenya ARV guidelines 2022 · unaids.org · INTERVAL · pmc · Malawi floods and ART · pmc · ARV shortage 2026 · standardmedia.co.ke

✓ April 2024 floods · thestandard.ke · peopledaily.digital · KCSE 2026 dates · capitalfm.africa

✓ KMD Lake Victoria forecast · meteo.go.ke · HIGHWAY · wmo.int · BAMS paper · Pier sinking 2021 · nation.africa · Drowning and life jackets · pmc · Fishers' causes of death · ku.ac.ke

✓ Ogilo gauge · capitalfm.africa · Kibuon 2025 · kenyans.co.ke · KMD apology · citizen.digital

✓ Jinja releases 2020 · circleofblue.org · South Sudan floods · theeastafrican.co.ke · Release policy · monitor.co.ug

✓ KRCS flood EAP · anticipation-hub.org · MDRKE058 · ifrc.org · MDRKE070 · ifrc.org · Imminent DREF guidance · anticipatory-action.org

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✓ Homa Bay Emergency Fund Act 2016 · countyassembliesforum.org · FLLoCA allocations · treasury.go.ke · Inua Jamii June 2026 · citizen.digital · ARC · africasustainabilitymatters.com

✓ GiveDirectly Kenya 2026 · givedirectly.org · Pople et al. 2021 · anticipation-hub.org

✓ FEWS NET Kenya, Jul and Sep 2026 · fews.net · fews.net · Ferry groundings · kenyanews.go.ke · Hermetic bags · ageconsearch.umn.edu · Omena drying · eanso.org · CGIAR fish preservation · cgiar.org · Omena prices · nation.africa

◦ KMD OND 2026 outlook · meteo.go.ke · 2020 displacement · the-star.co.ke · nation.africa · Lake record 2020 · nation.africa · Dec 2019 floods · kenyanews.go.ke · 2023 displacement · peopledaily.digital · El Niño death toll 2023 · citizen.digital · Suba South drownings 2024 · nation.africa · Governor 2024 · the-star.co.ke · County El Niño plan 2023 · kenyanews.go.ke · Nairobi evictions 2024 · hic-net.org · Net misuse · doaj.org · icsf.net · Beach outreach · lvcthealth.org · Night whistles · mwananchi.co.tz

Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory

Generated 13 October 2026 for Homa Bay town, Homa Bay County, Kenya. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

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